

COLLECTION · BUYERS

Choosing the Right Neighbourhood

*Laval and the North Shore — find the area that
fits your life*

READ BEFORE YOU BEGIN

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Choosing the Right Neighbourhood

Laval and the North Shore — find the area that fits your life

You can renovate everything in a house except its location. Choosing the right neighbourhood in Laval or on the North Shore means protecting your quality of life AND your property's resale value.

This guide gives you a method for assessing an area: transit, services, schools, development, atmosphere and resale — applied to the realities of Laval, Terrebonne, Repentigny, Blainville, Mirabel and surroundings.

Each chapter ends with a lined “My notes” page to compare your favourite areas.

“Location, location, location”: the neighbourhood weighs as much as the property on your quality of life and your resale. This guide gives you an objective method to compare areas of Greater Montréal, from Laval to the North Shore.

The idea: replace the crush with a grid of criteria — then confirm on the ground before committing.

CHAPTER

The method for assessing a neighbourhood

Equipping yourself with an objective grid rather than a crush.

A good neighbourhood isn't judged by its pretty street alone. Assess each area on concrete criteria and weight them according to YOUR reality (family, remote work, transit).

- Commuting: access to highways (15, 25, 440, 640), bridges, commuter train, real travel time to your work at rush hour.
- Nearby services: grocery stores, pharmacies, clinics, shops, recreation.
- Schools and daycares: proximity, reputation, capacity.
- Safety and quiet: traffic, noise, street atmosphere.
- Development: upcoming projects that can improve (or densify) the area.

Score each area on concrete criteria: proximity to work and transit, schools, shops, safety, noise, development projects and resale potential. An objective grid keeps you from paying a premium for a pretty street whose daily life won't suit you.

EMILIE'S TIP

Test the home-to-work commute at the real rush hour, not on a Sunday. In Laval and on the North Shore, a 15-minute difference on a bridge can change your daily life for years.

CHAPTER

Laval: many different faces

Understanding the diversity of Laval's areas.

Laval isn't a uniform block: mature, well-served areas (near metro stations and major arteries) sit alongside newer, family-oriented developments on the outskirts. Prices, atmosphere and building type vary a lot from one neighbourhood to another.

- Proximity to the metro and major centres: convenience and resale.
- Recent family areas: new houses, schools, but sometimes services still developing.
- Waterfront and established areas: character and stability, often at a premium.

In Laval, reality changes from one area to another: proximity to metro stations and major arteries, mature neighbourhoods vs recent developments, access to services. Price and lifestyle vary greatly — hence the importance of targeting the area, not just the city.

EMILIE'S TIP

In Laval, ask yourself whether you want the convenience of a mature area or the space of a recent development. Both are valid — but they don't attract the same buyer at resale.

CHAPTER

The North Shore: space and suburban life

Weighing the appeal of the northern crowns.

Terrebonne, Mascouche, Repentigny, Blainville, Boisbriand, Sainte-Thérèse, Mirabel: the North Shore often offers more space for the price, a family setting and nature — sometimes at the cost of a longer commute to Montréal.

- Advantages: bigger houses, lots, family atmosphere, recent developments.
- To consider: distance and travel time, car dependency, services depending on the area.
- The commuter train and highway arteries greatly change an area's appeal.

The North Shore (Terrebonne, Mascouche, Repentigny, Blainville, Boisbriand, Sainte-Thérèse, Mirabel) often offers more space for your money, at the cost of a longer commute. Weigh the daily travel time, access to services and school offerings according to your stage of life.

EMILIE'S TIP

On the North Shore, access to structuring transit (train, highway) is a major value factor. A well-connected area resells better than an isolated one, at equal price.

CHAPTER

Thinking resale from the start

Choosing a neighbourhood that will protect your investment.

The neighbourhood you like must also appeal to your future buyer. Sought-after areas (good transit, good schools, services, low nuisance) resell faster and better, even in a slower market.

Be wary of elements that are hard to change and that hold back resale: a very busy street, proximity to a nuisance (noise, industry), the flood risk of certain areas. A good price doesn't always offset a permanent handicap.

The neighbourhood you like must also appeal to your future buyer: sought-after areas (transit, reputable schools, services) resell better and resist downturns. Buying with resale in mind protects your stake even if your plans change.

EMILIE'S TIP

Buy the neighbourhood as much as the house. The most beautiful property in a declining area is a worse investment than an ordinary house in a sought-after one.

CHAPTER

Testing a neighbourhood before committing

Confirming on the ground, not just on paper.

A neighbourhood isn't judged by statistics alone. Before buying, go and **live it** a little:

- Visit at **different times** (morning, evening, weekend).
- Test the **commute** to work or school at rush hour.
- Scout out **shops, transit, parks** and daily services.
- Observe the **atmosphere** and the upkeep of the neighbouring properties.

These concrete checks reveal what no listing sheet says.

Nothing replaces the ground: visit at different times, test the home-to-work commute at rush hour, observe the upkeep of the neighbourhood. Twenty minutes on a Sunday can become fifty on a Tuesday. You buy a daily life, not just an address.

EMILIE'S TIP

Do the home-to-work commute at rush hour before buying, not on a Sunday at noon. Twenty minutes on a Sunday can become fifty on a Tuesday. You also buy a daily life, not just an address.

IN PRACTICE

Action plan

Your next steps, concretely.

This week

1. Set up my weighted criteria grid.
2. Test the real commutes to my work at rush hour.

Within 30 days

1. Visit my 2-3 favourite areas at different times (weekday/evening/weekend).
2. Check schools, services and development projects.

Next

1. Ask Emilie for the resale history and dynamics of my target areas.

To choose my area

1. Build my criteria grid and score each neighbourhood visited.
2. Test the daily commute and visit at different times before making an offer.

REFERENCES

Resources & glossary

- Criteria grid: a tool to objectively assess an area.
- Structuring transit: commuter train, metro, major arteries that support value.
- Mature vs recent area: established convenience vs space and new construction.
- Resale: a neighbourhood's ability to attract future buyers.
- Permanent handicap: an unchangeable nuisance that weighs on value.
- Months of inventory: an indicator of local market tension.
- Commuting: home-to-work travel time, to be tested at rush hour.
- Resale potential: how easily you can resell based on the area's lasting appeal.
- Nearby services: shops, schools, transit, health, recreation.
- Development project: a construction site or plan that can change an area's value.

GOING FURTHER

Quiz — test your knowledge

1. What you can't renovate is:

- A) The kitchen
- B) The location
- C) The roof
- D) The paint

2. To assess commuting, you must test:

- A) A Sunday
- B) The real trip at rush hour
- C) The night
- D) Never

3. Laval is characterized by:

- A) A single type of neighbourhood
- B) Very different areas (mature vs recent)
- C) No schools
- D) No metro

4. A typical advantage of the North Shore is:

- A) Less space
- B) More space for the price
- C) No nature
- D) No development

5. On the North Shore, a major value factor is:

- A) The colour of the houses
- B) Access to structuring transit (train, highway)
- C) The name of the street
- D) The maximum distance

6. Thinking resale means choosing a neighbourhood that will appeal:

- A) Only to me
- B) Also to my future buyer
- C) To no one
- D) To the seller

7. A permanent handicap to watch for is:

- A) A nice view
- B) A very busy street or a nuisance
- C) A park
- D) A school

8. The best approach is to buy:

- A) The house only
- B) The neighbourhood as much as the house
- C) At random
- D) The nicest house no matter the area

Answer key

- 1. **B** — Location is the king criterion (intro and ch. 4).
- 2. **B** — Real travel time at peak is what counts (ch. 1).
- 3. **B** — The diversity of areas is great (ch. 2).
- 4. **B** — Space and a family setting (ch. 3).
- 5. **B** — Connectivity supports value (ch. 3).
- 6. **B** — Sought-after areas resell better (ch. 4).
- 7. **B** — These elements hold back resale (ch. 4).
- 8. **B** — The area protects the investment (ch. 4).

Signé PAR Em

*Thank you for reading. May this guide help you
decide with confidence, with all the information
in hand.*

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